Teacher copy · Keyboard Patterns & Note Names

Each workbook page faces its Lesson Book page. Pattern first, names second -- the same order at every age: older beginners take this chapter in one sitting, younger ones live in the patterns for a while before the names stick. Everything happens by ear and by eye on the keyboard; no staff yet (the Queen of G and the King of F wait for the Reading chapter -- here only "the low and high voices meet at middle C"). Loud and soft are not part of this chapter.

p. 2 Small house, big house

TOGETHER 1. **a small roof over every 2, a big roof over every 3 (4 roofs)**

AT HOME 1. **small houses 3, big houses 3**

PLAY 1. **bear (low): elephant, thunder, drum** 2. **bird (high): mouse, bell, whistle**

Watch for

Counting the black keys one by one instead of seeing the groups. Taking "higher" as further up the piano lid. The black keys are the roofs: the shape is what matters.

If stuck, try saying

"Look for the shapes, not the keys -- two together, three together."

p. 3 The white keys of each house

TOGETHER 1. **C D E one colour (twice), F G A B the other (twice)**

AT HOME 1. **S (D)** 2. **B (G)** 3. **S (C)** 4. **B (B)** 5. **B (F)** 6. **B (A)**

Watch for

This is the chapter's key idea: the white keys belong to a house -- 3 under the small roof, 4 under the big. A student who sees this grouping finds every note name, and later every scale fingering, from the pattern instead of counting from the bottom.

If stuck, try saying

"Every white key lives under a roof."

p. 4 The seven letter names

TOGETHER 1. **C D E F G A B**

AT HOME 1. **G** 2. **E** 3. **A** 4. **E** 5. **E** 6. **F**

PLAY: any word from A to G, played letter by letter.

Watch for

The most common stumble: crossing into F G A at the three-black-key roof. Anchor C and F at their left doors and walk from there. Also watch for an "H" (there is none -- after G comes A again) and for counting up from A at the bottom.

If stuck, try saying

"C and F are the left doors. Find the door, then walk."

p. 5 The whole piano & middle C

TOGETHER 1. **7 small houses**

AT HOME 1. **7 big houses** 2. **the kennel over the 2nd key from the bottom (A♯0/B♭0)** 3. **the star on the 24th white key from the left: middle C**

Watch for
Losing count on the long keyboard -- tick each house as it is counted so none is counted twice. Check middle C at the piano, not only on paper.

If stuck, try saying
"Count the small houses to 4. Middle C is the door just to its left."

p. 6 Play on the patterns

TOGETHER 1. **2 3 4 (left to right)**

AT HOME 1. **4 3 2 4 3 2 2 2 2 2 3 3 3 3 4 3 2**

PLAY: one unbroken line through all six pots. Then hear Hot Cross Buns legato.

Watch for
Fingers 2 3 4 only, in both hands: 1 and 5 wait for C position. Lifting the hand between notes (a gap) or holding both keys down (a blur). Check the chapter 1 habits while it plays: round hand, wrist back to level. Echo game: play 2-3 black keys, the student plays them straight back; grow to 4-5 as it gets easy.

If stuck, try saying
"Like a relay baton: hold on until the next note sounds, then let the old one go. No gap between the two sounds."

p. 7 Check-up

A 1. **S B S B**

B 1. **A (the right-hand dot)** 2. **C (the right-hand dot)** 3. **G (the right-hand dot)** 4. **B (the right-hand dot)**

C 1. **B (G)** 2. **S (E)** 3. **B (B)** 4. **S (C)**

D 1. **A** 2. **F** 3. **D** 4. **D**

E 1. **4** 2. **2** 3. **3** 4. **2**

F 1. **top** 2. **bottom** 3. **top** 4. **bottom**

Chapter 1's five checks still come first, every time at the piano. This chapter's five checks are shown on the keyboard (find the houses, say 3 and 4, name any white key, find middle C, Hot Cross Buns legato); you only correct. Score each concept on its own (4 marks each, pass 3+).

If a concept is not passed, go back to: **A** Lesson step 1, workbook page 2 · **B** Lesson step 1, workbook page 2 · **C** Lesson step 2, workbook page 3 · **D** Lesson step 3, workbook page 4 · **E** Lesson step 5, workbook page 6 · **F** Lesson step 5, workbook page 6